

ing a connection utilising Ethernet port, you need to either place the router near the television or have a long Ethernet wire. Wireless connection can cause issues whilst streaming videos or full movies, especially in FHD resolution. The Ethernet connection is more stable and offers better streaming options.

With smart TVs you also get apps and a user interface (UI). But each manufacturer uses his own UI and apps in order to make his product unique. Apps can range from videos, games and lifestyle to social networking like Facebook and Twitter. Researching on the types of apps that a manufacturer is providing is recommended for using your smart TV to its full capacity.

Further, the UI can make a world of difference too. Test out different UIs before you buy your TV.

Like the smartphones, smart TVs can download the latest apps, so that the TV can run at its best. If you are not really an apps person, it is better to consult an apps-savvy person. Also ensure that you do not have a download limit on your Internet connection as most apps consume data regularly.

There is usually a specified button in remote control that gives you access to all the smart features like apps and other Internet-based controls. This can

be a major turn off for some as remote of a smart TV tends to be more complex than your usual remote.

Many manufacturers offer specific apps, which turn your smartphone into a remote control for your television. This solves problems like typing.

Some other aspects

There are other aspects to a smart TV too. For example, if you want to connect your computer to the TV you should look for a TV that has the digital living network alliance (DLNA) feature available. Then you need to ensure that your computer or laptop is connected to the same network as the smart TV. This helps you connect both the devices.

Most smart televisions start from around 140cm (55-inch) screens, going on to 216cm (85-inch) and more. Now, you cannot just install such a huge television any where. Can you? Also, you might want to figure out which TV best suits the aesthetics of your room.

Almost all good retail outlets have smart TVs up for sale. You can check out the TVs here before you choose one; something that you cannot do when buying online. Consequently, online retail websites almost always have offers on these devices, whilst physical outlets wait for specific seasons or time of the year. This seems to leave you with a good option: go out to retail outlets, browse, learn and understand these devices, then come home and buy them online from a trustworthy e-retailer.

As you are buying a futuristic TV, do not be afraid to experiment with its technology. That said, do not get carried away. When researching for apps, look for that perfect mix of things you like doing and things you would not mind trying. If you find something new that suits you, add it to your daily arsenal of applications. Smart TVs provide you with an opportunity not only to enhance your TV viewing experience but also to use the idiot box for a lot more activities. So go for it and multiply your hobbies and interests. ●

The author is a correspondent at EFM

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Unit No. G-5, B Wing, Uday Bhavan No. 2, Plot K-3,
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